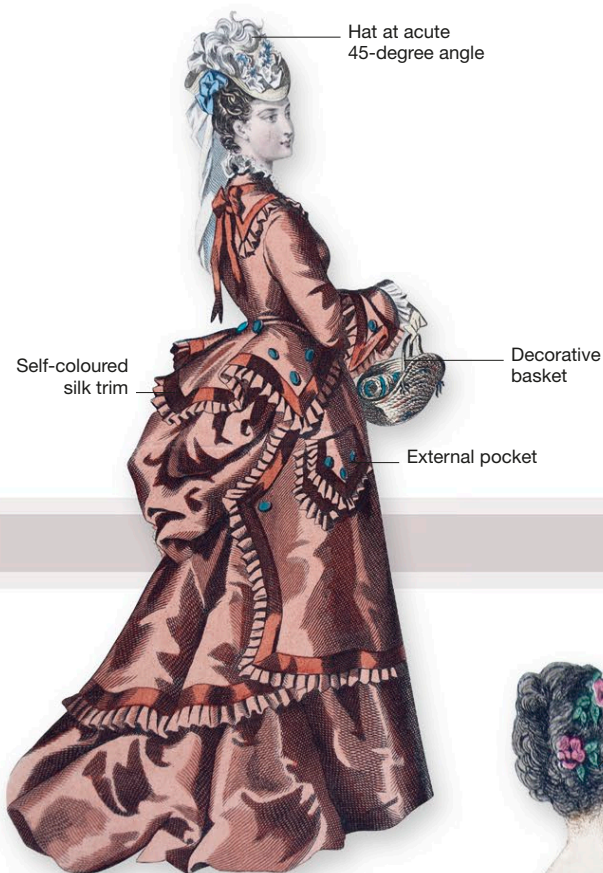




Bronze outfit This beautiful bronze-brown ensemble has a self-coloured silk ribbon trim. The blue buttons and blue hair ribbons create an unusual colour combination with the bronze, a look specific to 1872–74.



Walking suit This olive-green silk outfit has a long jacket, fitted to the body and flaring at the hem; the band collar is trimmed with machine-made cream lace. The panelled skirt is gathered up at the front.

1878



Evening gown This 1878 dress in blue and white – colours reminiscent of Chinese porcelain – has layers of tulle and lace at the front. It includes the practical feature of a dust ruffle that could be removed and washed.



1874



Parisian style This up-to-the-minute 1875 design shows the new style from Paris. The bustle is more restrained and the fish-tail train makes an appearance. Hips are at their slimmest for 50 years, and skirts are caught in around the knees, forcing a hobbled gait.

1875

BOOTS AND SHOES

Higher heels began to alter the body's posture, tipping it forwards slightly, which emphasized the bustle skirts and carried through to the tilted hat. Heels were small (4 cm/1½ in) and stocky, and curved inwards at the back. Toes were squared off (as shown here), rounded, or pointed. Most boots were black for everyday wear, but for weddings or balls, ivory satin or fine kid leather was used. Elastic sides were popular, using imported rubber, and uppers were decorated with bows and tassels.

